

Dying Light Special Edition

Fans of zombie related games this one is for you. You can now buy a special edition of Dying Light for a measly sum of \$387,000



GTA V delayed again

Rockstar announced that it'll be releasing GTA V for the PC on 14th April now, a month later than promised.

Streaming Devices

The Quirky Protocols

Miracast has been around for quite a long time and has been integrated into Android 4.2+ and Windows 8.1 which means all you need to do is be on the same network and you should be able to stream from A to B with ease. The reality is slightly different, Miracast doesn't work across all devices. We noticed that the HTC One M8 had quite a lot of issues mirroring itself



Google Chromecast

than the Nexus 4. Also, there is this major drawback while playing media off the internet on your mobile device which is then Miracast to your TV, not enough bandwidth. Most of these dongles are designed with a 150 Mbps Wi-Fi adapter so a mobile device has to get content wirelessly, then render it after which it is compressed and sent over the same Wi-Fi radio to the dongle. This effectively halves the bandwidth available for each operation and that makes the viewing experience cumbersome. Airplay on the other hand, simply tells the device where to fetch the media from, i.e. it sort of sends a URL so the media isn't hopping onto your phone, iPad or iPod and then over to the TV. This makes it less prone to losing packet data, however, the protocol is only officially supported on Apple devices which adds to its woes. DLNA is still the way to go, the protocol is a lot more standardised so you can expect two

devices that support it to work without any quirks, unlike Miracast. Hosting a media server is by far the best way to stream media across multiple devices because pretty much every platform has an app. DIAL (Discovery And Launch) is a relatively new protocol developed by YouTube and Netflix which had been previously implemented on the Google Chromecast. There aren't many devices that support this protocol which makes it seem as if it is heading into an early grave. Even the Chromecast has ditched DIAL in favour of mDNS (Multicast Domain Name System) which works in a similar

Configuration service akin to Apple's Bonjour and Avahi.

Winners

Owing to the lack of competition in this comparison test we're awarding only one product from each category. These awards are based off their overall weighted scores. We weighed performance and features the highest with the factor of build quality and value for money coming in much lower in

the scale. The results were hardly surprising.

Stick Ematic Mediabeam

EZCast dongles might not have any curated content but with



Ematic Mediabeam

the number of protocols being supported on this one piece of hardware, they were neck-and-neck with the Google Chromecast. The Chromecast has channels with curated content but most of them are region locked and getting them to work here requires a little extra investment which vastly reduces the value for money factor. We're of the opinion that the Amazon Fire Stick, if it has been a competitor, might have suffered a similar fate in our tests. The Chromecast is a much better performer while the Ematic dongle

would start losing packets and end up looking fuzzy when you started to move around with the mobile that was casting. At the end of the day, from among all the EZCast dongles we tested, the Ematic scored higher because of the external antenna helping it out in an ever so miniscule manner and the fact that there were more accessories with the dongle that gave it an edge over its comrades and won it the **Best Buy Award**.

Box Minix Neo X8-H Plus

The moment we took out the Neo X8-H Plus out of the packaging and went over the specifications, we knew it was going to win the **Best Performer** award and it did. The manufacturers took a high-powered SoC and slapped on it a choice of interfaces. Thus, giving the consumer the flexibility of picking whichever interface they are most comfortable with. Moreover, the Neo A2 mouse that is clubbed with these devices makes it into a game console of sorts. All of this is packaged in a well built compact package and it performed really well from even 10 meters away. And that's the farthest distance that someone would end up watching their TV from. The price that we've got here is that of the Minix Neo X8-H Plus clubbed with the Neo A2 air mouse but you can find the same package available for around 15K online and that only builds the case for the Minix Neo X8-H Plus. It's slightly low powered variant, the Neo X7 isn't a bad purchase either and you'll only notice the difference when you're playing games. These devices support 2K and 4K media playback so when these resolutions do achieve mainstream popularity you won't need to grab another media player. **1**



Minix Neo X8-H Plus